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AGRARIAN TRANSITION AND SOCIAL DEVELOPMENT IN ORISSA

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Succession of modes of production indicates the development of a society. That is the development of the productive forces, induces 'changes in the economic system, ultimately paving the way for complete liberation'.[1] While considering the development of free India, we can not initiate our discussion without referring to British era. It is the advent of British imperial economy which initiated a transition in Asiatic mode of production in India. By the introduction of private property and an external investment of capital, the transition was given effect to. However, theory of development in between late 1960s and mid 1970s witnessed the prominence of the 'dependency theory' and later 'world system' analysis in radical development studies. Leftist scholars and activists set "a recognition of class nature of development the importance of class struggle as the motor force of history, the centrality (i.e. core role) of working class in the struggle against capitalism and imperialism, with the accompanying struggle for social transformation through revolution".[2]

In this article, we defy this dependency theory as it fails to take account of the real agents of surplus appropriation. The central issue, is imperial exploitation located in the class structure and in the class struggle. The inevitability therefore arises that this problem must be examined and eventually resolved.

The economic system built up during the British Rule in general is understood as colonial economy. In rural life of India and in its major economy — agriculture we still find the impact

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of this old mode of production and the old production relations. They are changed to some extent no doubt but the changes are not so wide and deep going as to qualitatively introduce a new agro-economy. Hence this aspect we have to examine.

However this paper is an attempt to identify and discern structural inconsistencies which have developed or evolved during the post independence period — for this is the period in which State interventions have been directed in favour of attainment of egalitarian social structure.

The pre-reform agrarian structure revealed the impact of colonial mode of production 'superimposed on Asiatic mode of production'[3]. The British created the pre-requisites for the capitalist development of agriculture by introducing individual ownership over land (i. e. peasant proprietorship) and largescale landownership. It invaded and penetrated the 'self sufficient village economy' of India and substituted it by the 'Commercial Market Economy' though in a limited manner.

Whatever might have been the constructive role of colonialism in India, it above all manifests itself as destructive in all respects. Marx continues to show that the British destroyed the very Indian civilization, its communities, its industry and all that was great in Indian society. "The historic pages of their (i. e. British) rule in India report hardly anything beyond that destruction ..... The profound hypocrisy and inherent barbarism of burgeois civilization lies unveiled before our eyes, turning from its home, where it assumes respectable forms, to the colonies, where it goes naked. The devastating effects of English industry in India ..... are palpable and confounding".[4]

Under the colonial land tenure system, in Orissa, the State had no direct contact with the owner, least was the contact with the producer. Implementation of the 'Permanent Settlement' created a set of stable allies forming an intermediary class between the tillers of the land and the foreign rulers. Capitalist relationships were slow to develop in Zamindari areas. Incentive for the agricultural labour was marginal. Wage was for minimum subsistence. Because the impact of capitalist expansion on the archaic structures varied from region to region being conditioned by local circumstances, the type of capitalistic penetra-

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tion and the intensity of the penetration. The result however was almost always to create hybrid structures partly tending to behave as a capitalistic system and partly penetrating the features of the previously existing feudal system. The phenomenon of underdevelopment today is precisely a matter of this type of dualistic economy. Illegal exactions and rackrenting became a common feature with the high-handedness of different layers of intermediaries or absentee landlords. Another feature was that there appeared to be a close inverse relation between the percentage of area under commercial crops and level of living of agricultural labourer class.[5] Thus commercialisation under the colonial mode of production did not contribute to improvement of living standards of the masses.[6]

Thus the displacement of the European economic frontier almost always resulted in the formation of hybrid economies in which a capitalistic nucleus, so to speak, existed in a State of 'peaceful co-existence' with an archaic structure; the capitalistic nucleus rarely modified the pre-existing structural conditions but was linked with local economy merely as a formative element creating a mass of wages. There was no structural modification in the economic system — the basic step required for the creation of a typical capitalistic economy was not taken.

Even the forces of production were primitive, the structure of landholding and land-use was highly inequitable leading to lack of potency for growth and swelling the chunk of landless labourer and poor peasants as a build-in-depressor. Both relations of production and forces of production demanded changes in agrarian structure.

The Impact of Colonial Economy in Orissa :

The period in between 1803 to 1947 in the economic history of Orissa, was a period of economic stagnation and political unrest.

Colonial masters separated the coastal region from the inland areas. Temporary settlements were introduced in the coastal districts of Cuttack, Puri, Balasore, fixing revenue on annual triennial basis initially. In 1836 these temporary settlements were established. Land was auctioned for a specific period

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to zamindars under whom a variety of intermediaries operated to collect rent in 'Mughal bandi' areas. In some areas rent and taxes were collected directly by British-officials, which were called 'Khas Mahals.' In temporary settlement of zamindari areas, the land rent moved up steadily since the zamindar had to deposit his quota of revenue and maintain himself at the same time.[7]

However, as soon as products have become commodities in the external relations of a community, they also by reaction, become, commodities in the internal life of the community.[8] This reverse way was significant not only for the sequence of events different in relation to Western Europe, but also for the slower and different development in the East. Under this colonial policy, the peasant economy of Orissa greatly suffered. Surplus for sale in the market was almost an impossibility with vast number of small cultivators. That incapacitated them to fetch money to pay the cash rent. Small and poor peasants sold their land to landlords and in many areas they were forcibly dispossessed of their land due to their inability to pay land revenue or being unable to fulfil the zamindar's excessive socio-economic exactions.

This resulted in creating a number of smallholders on the one hand and an expanding stratum of landless labourers on the other. This policy also resulted in distress migration. The marketable surplus was not (or is not even now) a surplus over the needs of the producer. It is a 'forced surplus' at the cost of needs due to social and economic compulsions. Nothing of this factor is very essential as it has serious physical and social consequences.

Thus the self-sufficient village communities, in the 'round dozen' system, produced the same products, exchanged little between themselves. as there was no division of labour; only what emerged as surplus over the individual needs would be exchanged; and this must have been, considering the point about self sufficiency, very little.[9] Again as a result of British policy; cotton industry and some important cottage industries of Orissa disappeared as the cost of Britain's textile interests. Although some measures were taken to improve the infrastructures, the economy remained backward. As landholding groups, Brahmins

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and Karanas emerged more powerful than Khandayats because of their social status.

But this upper caste and class with their feudal way of living could hardly generate enough surplus and develop the economy. Marwari and Gujurati commercial capital which had entered in to Orissa by the later part of the 19th century had acquired a dominating position by the early 20th century. But they became a long-term handicap for the growth of local entrepreneureship. The regenerative role of colonial economy was hardly felt in Orissa and its economic condition did not show any improvement. The enquiry committee established by Government of India (1888) stated "in Bengal Presidency the struggle for existence was very severe in the case of people of Bihar and Orissa."[10] The Royal Commission on Agriculture (1926) reported about the poverty, low standard of living, indebtedness of cultivators, increasing population of agricultural labourer and poor economic condition of the common men in Orissa. The "Agrarian structure in colonial Orissa was feudal and semifeudal", although the peasant proprietorship also constituted a sizable segment of the agrarian economy.

Rural economic stratification was largely determined by size of holdings, tenancy status and caste composition. However, they had a common identity based on land use, mostly tied to each other in a complex sort of exploitative tenancy relationship, constraining efficiency in land use practices, perpetuating low productivity and agricultural backwardness."[11]

On the basis of this complex inter woven socio-economic structure of colonial desidiratum; a striving has been made here to analyse and assess the extent of development of Orissa after independence.

According to the provisional population figure of 1991, Orissa has 315 lakh of total population and the 86.57% of it constitute rural population. The density of population is 202 per square kilometre. Agricultural sector continues to dominate the economy of the State absorbing 80% of the workforce and contributing more than 50% of the State domestic product.[12] Over the period, the working population in agraian sector was 70. 33% in 1951, 73. 83% in 1961, 77.44% in 1971, 74.65% in

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1981, and 80% in 1991.[13] This indicates a growing dependence of more and more population on the agrarian sector. Hence this primary sector is crucial to the growth of State's economy. Output of this sector is determinant one. Any fluctuation of thef orces contributing it shakes the whole economy of the State.

Starting from the First upto Seventh Plan period always emphasis has been given over better productivity of crops. We have to observe here the yield of both food grains and that of cash crops, to assess their trend in the total production process of the State. Commercial cropping is an important factor to fathom the extent of capitalist trend in agriculture; which is primarily not for self-consumption inside the domestic market; rather directed towards outside market. Non-food grain has demonstrated very poor figure i. e. 15% in 1984-85, 15.3% in 85 86, and in 86-87, 16 5% in 1987-88 and 88-89, 16.6% in 89-90. and 16.7% in 1990-91.[14] 1.7% unsteady increase of non-food crop production since 1984-1991 is not an encouraging figure. It tends to somewhat stagnant trend which is not healthy a proposition for commercial cropping pattern.

On the other hand food grains contain the largest segment of the total cropping pattern of Orissa i.e. 85% in 1984-85, 84% in 1985-87, 83.5% from 1987-89, 83.4% in 1989-90 and 83.4% in 1990-91.[15] Such a large percentage of investment in food grains again show a non-commercial cropping trend and confirms to consumption based production.

Rice being the principal crop, has also fluctuated over the years due to erratic monsoon and low irrigational facilities. The position of Orissa in terms of productivity of rice is still significantly lower than that of many other States and that of all India average. It ranks 12th in the ladder showing 11.8 quintals yield rate of rice per hectare at teriennium ending of 1987-90 where as national figure was 16.4 quintals per hectare.[16] In 1990-91 figure yield rate of food grains has shown a low figure of 9 84 quintal per hectare,[17] Specifically rice as a major food crop; its yield rate has declined over the period also. It was 12.37 during 1988-89 and 14.31 in 89-90 and it sharply came down to 11.8 quintal per hectare in 1991.[18] This happens very often due to many structural and operational constraints like agro-ecological variation, fragmented holdings, absentee landlordism, econo-

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mically poor status of the farmers, saline tracts, water logging conditions etc.

The net State Domestic Product of Orissa is highly influenced by income generated from the agricultural sector. The net domestic product of the State at 1980-81 prices showed a mixed trend during first four years of the 7th Plan. The State income remained almost static for two years as it was Rs. 3980.82 crores in 1985-86 and Rs. 3979.21 cr. in 1986-87. But it has sharply declined to Rs. 3922.04 cr. during 1987-88. Then it recovered to Rs. 4391.87 cr. during 1988-89 due to sharp rise of income under agricultural sector.[19]

While reviewing the status of sectoral contribution to the States Net Domestic Product during the 7th Plan period, a similar trend as in 6th Plan was observed. Primary sector claimed a major share of the total State income followed by services, tertiary and secondary sectors of the State economy according to the size of the contribution. In fact, primary sector contributed 63.6% of the total State income in 1985-86, 62.6% in 1986-87, 58.3% in 1987-88 and 61.5% in 1988-89.[20] Services sector which followed the primary sector, contributed an average of 15% of the total State income during the first four years of 7th plan. Similarly tertiary sector (11% on an average) is the other nominal contributor of State income during the 7th plan.

The contribution of the agricultural sector alone to NSDP at constant (1980-81) prices has declined to 45% from 47.5% in the previous year i.e. 1989-90, registering a decline of 5.3% in this sector. According to quick estimates NSDP at current and constant (1980-81) prices in 1990-91 have been Rs. 9,929 crore and Rs. 4855 crore respectively against Rs. 9105 crore and Rs. 4848 crore respectively during the year 1989-90.[21] It goes to suggest that the variations in the NSDP was dependent mainly on primary sector involving agriculture and allied services. Now it has become inevitable to mark the trend of the facilitating forces of this primary sector's output. Irrigation and use of fertilisers are two main determinants of agricultural production. According to 1991 provisional census of India, only 26.7% of net area are irrigated upto 1986-87. The State ranks eleventh in the irrigational map of the country. The identified irrigation potential is 49.5% to altimate irrigation potential upto 1989-90;

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where as corresponding statistics for Haryana and Punjab are 64.8% and 88.5% respectively.[22]

Consumption of fertiliser in the State is as low as 21.7 Kg. per hectares. While comparing it to other States' position, it lags behind at the 17th position by the year 1989-90.[23] It is highest in three other states of Punjab, Tamil Nadu and Haryana having 158.6 Kg., 119.7 Kg. and 94.4 Kg. respectively where capitalistic pattern of agriculture is already resumed. Consumption of fertilisers in the State has declined from 2.05 lakh Mts in 1989-90 to 1.93 lakh Mts. in 1990-91 registering a fall of 5.9%.[24] These figures indicate a slow progress in the trend of capitalist agriculture. Because improved means of production like scientific machineries, high yielding seeds, large coverage of irrigational facilities, high rate of fertiliser consumption are pre-conditions for capitalistic pattern of agricultural practices. But these investment in terms of qualitative and quantitative inputs are highly lacking and made the production handicap to reach its feasibility.

Excluding all above forces of production; land is the most vital form of capital; the use of which depend mostly on the holding class and its relations with production process. As such agriculture in the State of Orissa is characterised by the preponderance of small and marginal holdings. As per the most recent data[25] available; by the end of 1985-86; marginal farmers who had land holding of less than one hectare constituted 52 09% of total operational holding occupying 17.5% of area. Where as 24.8% of small holders having land between 1 to 2 hectres contained 24.2% of area. Semi-medium farmers having land between 2 to 4 hectres hold 16.27% of operational holding and 29.8% of area where as middle peasants who have 4 to 10 hectres of landed property constitute only 5.69% of holding and of 22.2% area. Rich peasants who have large holdings in between 10 to 50 hectres and above, constitute only 0.57% of operational holding with 6.3% of area. This indicate the highest percentage of marginal farmers having smallest percentage of area under them to cultivate. And the minimum percentage of rich peasants who generally do not work, having highest percentage of area under them. By this the actual tiller gets alienated from lands.

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Over a period of time since 1970-71 and 1980-81[26] upto 1985-86[27], there has been some changes in the size of holding spectrum of the State. Marginalisation has increased over the years. It was constituting 44.6% of total agricultural work force in 1970-71, which was increased to 46.8% in 1980-81 and reached at 52.09% by the year 1985-86. It means landed people are losing their land and getting marginalised gradually. Though semi-middle class peasantry has shown a growth rate since 1970-71 upto 1980-81 securing 13.7% and 18.4% of operational holding respectively. It has declined to 16.27% towards 1985 86, which means this class has broken and started merging with marginal class and landless labourer.

All other categories have also declined. But a sharp fall is marked in case of large holdings i.e. from 1.47% to 0.8% by the year 1970-71 to 1980-81. Again it has come down to 0 57% by the year 1985-86. Area under this upper class has also come down from 12.5% to 7.4% in this decade (1970-71 to 1980-81). And still it came down to 6.3% in 1985-86. This shows the State has very few big farms having landed property between 10 to 50 hectres and above. Agriculture has lost its lure for the well-to-do also. It is a depressing note for capitalistic farming. Decrease in area under big operational holding has given way to land fragmentation.

Not only that medium holders have also lost their area of holding from 27.8% to 24.9% between 1970-71 and 1980 81 which has again come down to 22.2% in 1985-86. It is interesting to know that comparatively area under big holders are breaking. It is only middle peasantry i.e. 5.69% of operational holdings have 22.2% of total cultivated area. One can mark the dominant tendency of middle farmers who are mostly inequipped with any type of capitalist means of production rather attached to semi-feudalistic pattern. The position of agricultural labourer has swelled 17.01% to 28.28% 1960-61 to 1970-71; where it has declined marginally from 1970-71 to 1980-81 i.e. from 28.28% to 27.65%. Again it has increased slightly to 28.85% in 1991. But the overall picture of last two decades do not show any such swell of agricultural labourer. Though it has also shown any depression, Wage-labour system is a prerequisite condition for capitalist farming. The relationship between agricultural labourer who sales his labour and peasant proprietor who

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purchase is basically capitalist but every peasant proprietor who engages farm hands for cultivating his land is not a capitalist, neither he has capitalist farming. Cultivators have declined steadily over the years since 1961, upto 1991. It was 56.82% in 1961, 49.16% in 1971, 47% in 1981[28] and came down to 44.21% in 1991.[29] This means pauperisation is growing first.

Percapita income is another economic indicator to measure social development. Percapital income estimates at current and constant prices (1980-81) have been Rs. 3179.66 and Rs 1554.67 respectively. The first revised estimates of percapita income for 1989-90 at current and constant (1980-81) prices are Rs. 2946.97 and Rs. 1578.74 respectively. In real terms, the growth of NSDP during 1991 over the previous year 1989-90 has been very marginal (0.14%). Where as there has been a slight decline in the percapita income at constant prices in 1990-91 over 1989-90.[30]

According to Planning Commission's estimates the percentage of population below poverty line in Orissa has increased by 2% between 1983-84 and 1987-88 in contrast to a reduction by 7.5% at all India level.

Above comparative analysis speaks that Orissa has shown a negative sign almost in respect of all indicators of economic development. Orissa remained unaffected and experienced no remarkable sign of modern economic transition due to primitive agricultural technique, insufficient irrigation, land fragmentation, uneconomic holdings, growing marginalisation and pauperisation, over pressure on agriculture, alarming rural indebtedness and above all the existing land relations. However the fact could be noted that in some districts like Sambalpur, Ganjam. Puri, Cuttack and Balasore the trend of production forces are just taking shape of precapitalist mode, with the help of SRPP programme in 1988-89. Apart from this, concerted efforts by the extension machinery of Government coupled with increased consumption of fertilisers, large coverage of high yielding varieties, better management of weeds and control of pests and diseases, harnessing of water resources and provision of incentive to farmers. All these factors and processes in totality constitute the content of capitalist agriculture. No doubt these trends are in practice; but its growth is insignificant. Labour productivity, yield rates, commercial and non-food cropping and diversification of workforce is yet to get a boost up.

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From the above analysis we can come to the conclusion that in the existing pattern of agriculture; tenancy system, non-free and attached labourers, are the signs of semifeudal mode of production. But differentiation among the peasantry, secular stagnation, labour as commodity and a free wage labour system show partial development of capitalistic features in Orissan agriculture in a few pockets. These mixed symptoms characterise a partial transition in the mode of production reflecting semi-feudalistic elements.

Despite the above depressing trends in agricultural field; there is no doubt that it has taken the road of capitalist development minus the capitalist infrastructure. The operation of old feudal forms to give way to capitalist forms in agriculture. Also it goes without saying that if national capitalism could develop in full swing in every sphere of our economy the remnants of colonial backwardness and dependence could speedily be, wiped out from the face of our country. Therefore, the question is how strong the old feudal obstacles on the way of capitalist development in agriculture and what is its future?

The principal aim of land reforms measure was to bring about radical change in the agrarian structure based on social justice. The above analysis have shown the great inequality in the structure mainly on operational holding in 1985-86 figures. It is an indicator of poor implementation of land reforms measure in Orissa since 1960 onwards which is the prime institutional strumbling factor for the development of agriculture on which depend the overall development of the State.

There are two possible paths of development of Orissa's economy which is predominantly agrarian. One of them is 'capitalist' solutions and the other is the sub-altern way. The object of these solutions is to clear the remnants of feudal landownership for the development of productive force. Excepting this, the only common factor; they are vitally and basically different from one another.

Out of the two possible paths of the agrarian economy, India's constitution makers have chosen the path of compromise with the landlords and transforming feudal lords into capitalist landlords for the development of productive forces. At a glance

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this becomes crystal clear when non-cultivating ownership of agricultural land is protected under the principles of fundamental rights and at the same time ceiling is sought to be imposed with compensation to make farm holding managable and viable.

If various measures of agrarian reforms adopted by different legislatures and the Parliament during the last four decades are examined and scrutinised in this context, it becomes clear that they are following consistently this path and all their measures are directed in this direction. The history of post-independence land legislations in Orissa and other States of the country can be divided into three parts. Firstly, the abolition of political institutions of feudalism like zamindaries etc. and other intermediaries. Secondly, the acts and reforms for protection of tenants and tenural rights. Thirdly, implementation of ceiling laws and consolidation of holdings and non-government activities like Bhoodan and Gramdan programmes of Vinoba Bhave which was backed by the Government sanctions.

Certain important and progressive legislations were passed in Orissa after independence. Enforcement of OEA act 1951 has resulted in statutory abolition of intermediaries between the cultivators and the State. Secondly, certain categories of cultivators were granted permanent and hereditary rights in land for the first time and thirdly, burden of feudal illegal exactions were eliminated. The 'bethi' (forced labour), 'the begari' (unpaid labour), 'nazrana', 'veti' and all other 64 types of feudal taxes were declared to be abolished along with abolition of landlordism. While carrying out these reform programmes; the principles like compensation, preservation of landlord's estates and their privileges remained intact to landlord bourgeois path. Here to support our observations, Lenin's experience can be quoted; who said "compensation is a means for making the feudal methods of exploitation secure by bureaucratic and police means, in the shape of the bourgeois 'universal equivalent.'[31]"

Above land legislations aimed at abolition of intermediaries and transfer of land to the occupancy tenants, granting fixity of tenure and rent-reduction, imposing ceiling on landholdings and so on. There is no doubt that in many cases, by removing superior rights in lands such as the rights of statutory landlords, the jagirdars, inamdars etc. These legislations weakened considera-

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bly their economic domination in the rural areas and their grip on the rural economy. Of course, this should not mean that economic exploitation on cultivators has gone down, which in reality goes up year by year.

Due to these enactments, peasantry of Orissa has been stratified in to various groups. A class of rich peasantry including the former landlords has come up who get their farms cultivated by hired labour. Another class of middle peasantry has also emerged among the erstwhile tenants who have become peasant proprietors. This also include a sect from feudal landlords who had descended to the lower ladder. Their positions had weakened due to so many feudal disabilities. Next class constitutes the poor and marginal peasants. Where as under the last but not least class category comes the landless agricultural labourer.

Loopholes of OTP Act 1948 and OEA Act 1951 helped the zamindars and intermediaries to retain as much land as possible in the name of 'Sir' or 'Khudkasht' and guaranteed with huge amount of money by way of compensation. So they maintained their previous position taking the opportunity of the shortcomings in those enactments. The biggest flaw of the Zamindari Abolition Act, 1951 was that it did not pay due attention to the question of land redistribution and made no provision for imposition of ceiling on big landholdings, determination and taking over of surplus land. To facilitate these State has passed so many enactments, such as OTR Act 1955, OLR Act 1960-65, Consolidation of Holding Act 1972 and Ceiling Act in 1975.

Behind all these measures the policy makers tried to facilitate the capitalist development of agriculture. But the essential feature of all their legislative measures for liquidating the old forms of landownership is that they aim at gradual transformation of feudal landlords into capitalist landlords and substituting gradually the bourgeois methods of exploitation for feudal methods by transforming a bulk of peasants into landless labourer.

No doubt these reforms have been able to create a conducive atmosphere for better production within a limited section. But the level of capital accumulation and the rate of growth in

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agricultural sector, had been below the targeted aim. The reasons thereof have to be concretely studied and solved. Intervention from the top for the implementation of such a defective legislation could only provide paper rights to tenants and bring out a quasitransition in the agrarian structure. Thus the power balance again tilted against the rural poor. So far "one lakh and 24,000 cases have been instituted. Only 48,588 beneficiaries have been conferred with rayati rights in respect of 40.39 acres".

Upto the end of 1990-91 54,175 temporary leasees and 47, 596 sub-tenants have been conferred with rayati rights over 33, 654 acres and 18,072 acres respectively. Under O.L.R. Act, further, 46,360 'Bhag chasis' have been conferred with rayati right over 40,516 acres, 3,261 and 59 acres, of land respectively, by the end of 1900-91. 'Bhag chasis' have been conferred with 'Rayati' rights and the land concerned have been declared by revenue officer as non-resumable.[32]

Legislations granting fixity of tenure, first and foremost provide the right to landlord to resume land for self-cultivation from the possession of cultivating tenants upto a ceiling limit of 33 acres at first. In actual practice the landlords have been able to evict and uproot millions of tenants from land. Therefore, in actual practice on the whole, land has become scarce for the tenant-cultivators and land rent has increased. However, the conditions of the tenants has become no better than what it was before enactment of OTP Act 1948. Rather agrarian legislations including OLR act have accentuated disputes between landlords and tenants. Nearly 83,598 cases have been instituted out of which 79,268 have been disposed of, benefiting only 22,405 persons involving 9,559 hectares of land which shows the courts have proved to be pro-landlord by and large.

The policy pursued regarding ceiling on landholding has resulted in a farce. Although the ceiling was a part of Land Reforms Act, 1965; but long after in 1975 it was actually implemented in the State. The delay in enactment even though it was mooted in 1970 helped the big landowners to indulge in 'benami' transfers of land. In Orissa 76 lakh hectares of surplus agricultural land was estimated to be available at first but only 45.70 lakh hectares could be available for distribution among 89,161 people. It shows that hardly a little over one acre was

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distributed per beneficiary. Progressively till the end of 1990-91 out of a net area of 1,89,070 acres of ceiling surplus land vested in the possession of Government, a net area of 1,67,739 acres of land has been taken over and net area of 1,50,386 acres of total area distributed among 1,28,499 landless persons.[33]

On the top of all, they provide for total exemption of gardens, plantations, co-operative farms, dairy and cattle farms and so called efficiently emerged farms, the trust properties of deities etc. The net result of this legislation has been able to preserve their estates. This is not accidental but the inherent consequence of the path adopted by the prolandlord Congress party and other Governments of the type.

Another important aspect of the land reform legislations of the Congress Government is that the implementation of these measures is entrusted entirely on the bureaucrats who are recruited from the bourgeois-landlord class and serve their own class interests. In actual implementation of these legislations, the bureaucratic State machine works as a weapon in the hands of the landlords to uproot the poor peasants.

Though in 1951 Orissa Agricultural Act was passed for consolidation of holdings; but some inadequacies in this law compelled to pass Orissa Consolidation of Holdings and Prevention of Fragmentation of Land Act, 1972. But statutory operation under this law has been taken up in selected areas in the district of Cuttack, Puri, Balasore, Ganjam, Dhenkanal and Mayurbhanj during the year 1973 77. During 5th Plan period 0.46 lakh hectare, in 6th Plan, 3.48 lakh hectare, in 7th Plan 2.96 lakh hectare and during 1990-91 0.30 lakh hectare are the progress figure of consolidation of holdings. Total consolidation work was completed in 5154 villages with an area of 7.25 lakh hectares till the end of September' 91.

It was launched with a view to establish rationalisation of distribution of land among land owners for achieving better agricultural output. On the whole this has helped the landlords to restore to self cultivation evicting their tenants. In order to enable the land lords for self-cultivation, huge amount of money have been granted by way of L.D. loans for the purchase of agricultural machineries, fertilisers, for setting up of lift irrigation

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from rivers and tube wells and for extension of other irrigational facilities etc. The largest share of the benefit from the co-operative go to the upper section of land monopolists. The State machinery although geared to cater to such needs, had resulted in a model which has served the interests of a few classes, thus depriving the toiling millions at their just and legitimate share. This is because Indian intellectuals, policy makers and planners have never taken the development of productive forces as the indicator of the progressive nature of a given formation. They have neglected the fundamentals, i.e. the process of succession of modes of production as the process of development of human civilisation.

The present morbid systems characterising Orissa's socio-political scene are the products of confused policy framing on the part of the ruling elites which oblivious of both history and tradition, attempted to establish a hotch-potch design destroying both the traditional values as waves of development that accuse the development of history. It is because the progress in this sphere of capitalism is used in the selfish interests of the financial oligrachy and brings new fortunes (destructive) for the working people.

Indian social structures have strong historical learnings a fact which even Marxists cannot deny. In this paper we have analysed the intricate agrarian social structure of India as a whole as well as of Orissa in the post independence period. This incomplete agrarian transitional phase of political and economic contradictions is responsible for weak inter-class alliances making the peasant movements (at the State of Orissa and that of India), very much regional/local in nature and unsuccessful one.

But at the same time, the hegemonic apparatuses of the ruling class has a political role to play in bringing about changes in fundamental nature. For example in China, Mao took the help of Chinese history to transform the Chinese history and it could be described a positive xenophobia. On the contrary the Indian scene represents a hybrid structure where processes are overlapping each other and thus we find perpetual blurring on the part of Indian historiosophist.

But one cannot get rid of these contradictions by returning to past stages of development, but by struggle for more rapid

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progress for socialism. Because the force of history, its whirlwind are least sympathetic towards rosy slumbers. To manipulate nostalgia, to justify the status-quo is to push history into the limbo of oblivion. But it is not simple task. Such forces get unleashed through their own inner dynamism. Those scholars who try to display nostalgia at the cost of historical realities either fail to take stock of existing structural inconsistencies of escape from the hard realities of the present. And it is only after the victory of socialism, said Mark will human progress cease to resemble that hideous pagan idol, who would not drink the nectar but from the skulls of the slain.

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